

Week 1, Day 1 — presenter notes

Slides: open [week-01-day-01.html](#) in Chrome/Firefox → **F** fullscreen → arrows. **N** shows the speaker note for the current slide. **P** prints to PDF.

This session is **ideas + toolchain**. No SMS code. No slices. No REST.

Timing (3–3.5 hours)

Clock	Block	Slides
0:00–0:10	Welcome, course promise, outcomes	1–6
0:10–0:35	Software engineering + why Go	7–12
0:35–0:50	Pinned tools, GOPATH vs modules	13–15
0:50–1:40	Live install Go + VS Code + format on save	14–17
1:40–2:20	Live first program, export rule, run/build/gofmt	18–20
2:20–3:00	Live Git + GitHub	21–23
3:00–end	Lab checklist; collect GitHub URLs	24–27

If install overruns, cut stories on Why Go. **Never cut** `gofmt` or the GitHub push.

Live demo script

1. Install (Ubuntu)

Use the **exact** filename from <https://go.dev/dl/> on the day you teach (patch version may be 1.25.1, etc.). Do **not** `apt install golang-go`.

```
go version    # must say go1.25.x linux/amd64
go env GOROOT GOPATH
```

Windows students: Ubuntu app via **WSL2**, then the same commands. macOS: pkg from go.dev or Homebrew `go`, still check `go version`.

PATH pitfall: new terminal after editing `.bashrc`.

2. VS Code

1. Extension **Go** (Go Team at Google).

2. Command Palette → **Go: Install/Update Tools** → all.
3. User settings JSON → format on save (slide).
4. Ugly `hello.go` → save → it reformats. Applause optional.

3. First program

Type with them. File: `~/epic-go/hello/hello.go`.

```
package main

import "fmt"

func main() {
    fmt.Println("Hello, Epic Learn")
}
```

Show `fmt.Println` failing. Then:

```
gofmt -w hello.go
go run hello.go
go build -o hello hello.go
./hello
```

Do **not** `go build` today — there is no `go.mod` until week 4.

4. Git

```
git init
# .gitignore should include the binary `hello`
git add hello.go .gitignore
git commit -m "Add Hello Epic Learn"
```

Create empty GitHub repo → `remote add` → `push`. Collect the HTTPS URL.

Lab gate (they do not leave without)

- `go version` is 1.25.x
- Format on save works
- `go run` and `./hello` both print the message
- GitHub has `hello.go`, not the binary
- You have their repo URL

Homework

- `why-go.md` — half page, own words, why Go for SMS
- Screenshot of `go version`

Typical failures

Symptom	Fix
<code>go: command not found</code>	PATH / new terminal / WSL vs PowerShell
<code>go version</code> is 1.18 from apt	Remove distro Go; install from go.dev
Extension does nothing	Wrong folder opened; tools not installed
<code>undefined: fmt.Println</code>	Capital P — teaching moment
Push rejected	Token, 2FA, or remote README conflict
Huge file on GitHub	They committed <code>hello</code> binary

What not to teach today

Modules (`go mod init`), packages, functions as a topic, REST, Gin, PostgreSQL, the SMS repo. Tease SMS only.